

**DUNGEON
CRAWLER CARL**
ROLEPLAYING GAME



**PAR FOR
THE COURSE**



COMBAT SKILL ACTIONS

ACTION	WHAT IT DOES
Attack	Attack a foe within range.
Cast a Spell	Choose a Spell or scroll in your Hotlist, and roll a Spell Skill Check if it's an Attack. If it's a non-scroll Spell, spend Mana to cast it.
Catcher	Interrupt. Take a hit for another party member. You cannot Evade such damage.
Look for Clues	Using Perception, Investigation, or a related Skill, gain information about a Boss that you can use to your party's benefit.
Taunt	Interrupt. Attempt to redirect announced attacks against other party members to you. You can still Evade this attack.
Use a Skill	Make a Skill Check.

COMBAT NON-SKILL ACTIONS

ACTION	WHAT IT DOES
Call a Play	Encourage an ally to perform a particular non-Interrupt Action in combat. Roll 2d6. Ally adds the higher d6 roll to the Skill Check (if needed) or damage.
Evade	Interrupt. Roll a separate Evade check against each attack directed at you this combat round.
Healing	Interrupt. Use a Healing Potion or Healing Spell or Scroll. May also be used non-Interrupt.
Intervene	Interrupt. Roll 1d6. Add your result to a party member's d20 roll after determining whether or not the roll was a Success.
Move	Travel up to your Move + Step
Retrieve	Pull an item from your Inventory to your hand, the ground, or add it to your Hotlist.
Use a Hotlist Item	Use a Potion, Tool, Scroll, or other Item on your Hotlist

Back Nine Battle Baboon

Mob, Large (5), Primate

3	3	3	3
25%	50%	75%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
4	13	14	20 + S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
6 (+3)	1 (+1)	6 (+3)	3 (+2)	1 (+1)

Golf Club: 15 to hit, 1d6+3 Bludgeoning

Notes: If someone is hit by a golf ball, at least 1d4+1 Baboons in the vicinity attack that creature for that round.

Derrick Qu

Crawler, Medium (4), Human

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
7	14	16	25 + S	0
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
6 (+3)	3 (+2)	10 (+4)	11 (+4)	3 (+2)

Nutcracker: 15 to hit, 2d6+3 Bludgeoning

An unarmed strike to the crotch: On an Evade Major Fail or worse, a crawler with external genitals gains the Stunned Debuff

General Kong

Neighborhood Boss; Huge (6), Primate

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
10	14	16	20	4
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
19 (+4)	5 (+2)	15 (+4)	10 (+4)	6 (+3)

Kong Smash: 16 to hit, 3d6+4 bludgeoning, 5ft range

Explosive Barrel: 14 to hit, 2d8 Bludgeoning, 60ft range, 20ft Blast radius, (once per round)

Notes: *Commanding*—As an Action, General Kong shouts tactical commands at his Back Nine Battle Baboons to grant them all a bonus of +2 damage to their Golf Swing attacks. He does this only if all of the PCs are at 30% Health Bar or greater, and if there are at least three Baboons remaining.

Tyrannical Loyalty—If General Kong loses 4+ Health Bar slots in a single blow, the nearest Baboon (if any) dives in the way and takes the damage instead.



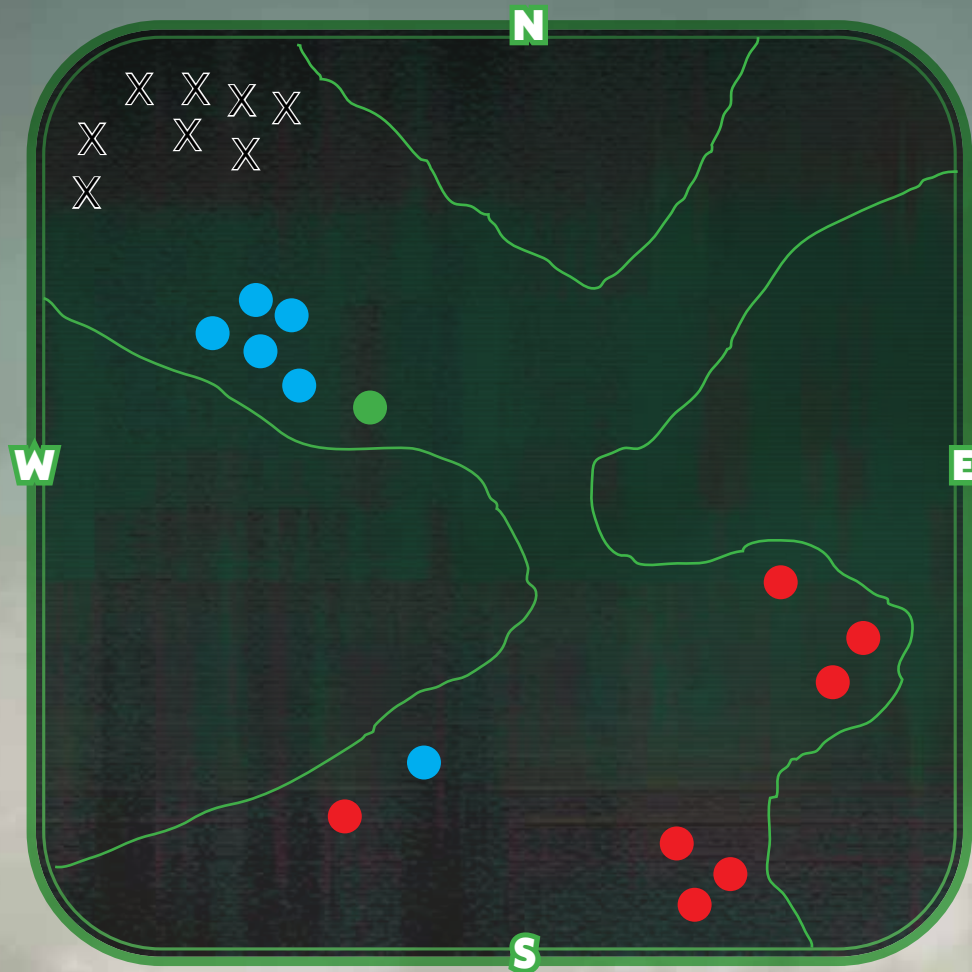
PAR FOR THE COURSE

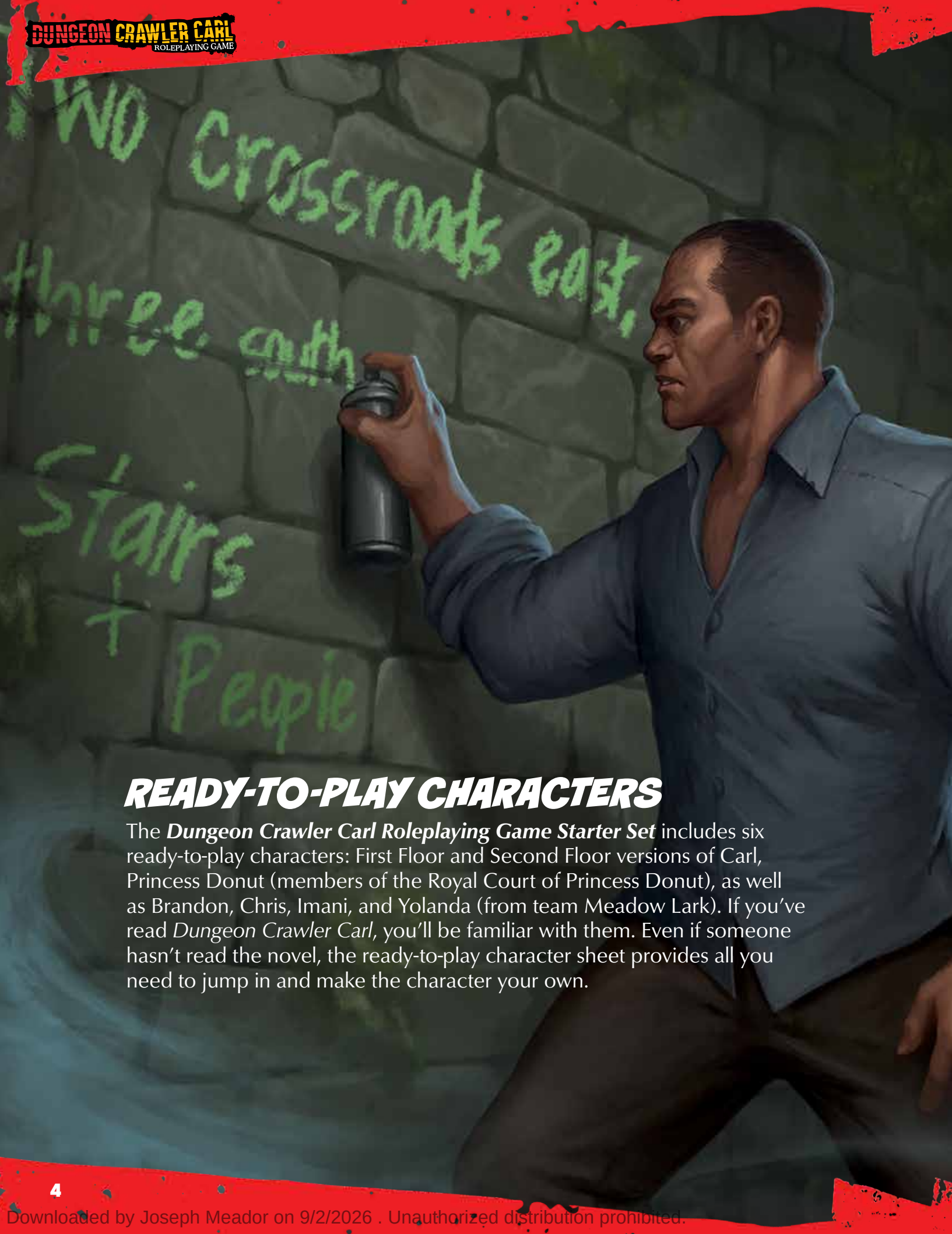


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READY-TO-PLAY CHARACTERS

The *Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game Starter Set* includes six ready-to-play characters: First Floor and Second Floor versions of Carl, Princess Donut (members of the Royal Court of Princess Donut), as well as Brandon, Chris, Imani, and Yolanda (from team Meadow Lark). If you've read *Dungeon Crawler Carl*, you'll be familiar with them. Even if someone hasn't read the novel, the ready-to-play character sheet provides all you need to jump in and make the character your own.



Brandon

A tough maintenance worker who protects his friends as a **tank**. Part of team Meadow Lark with his brother Chris, and nurses Imani and Yolanda.

Carl

Former Coast Guard mechanic, amateur explosives aficionado, and an expert melee pugilist **damage dealer**. Partnered with his ex-girlfriend's cat, Donut. Ally of team Meadow Lark.



Chris

A reserved and stoic man, Chris is the most perceptive character. He's a **damage dealer** who uses his spear, often positioned near his tanky brother Brandon. Chris is a member of team Meadow Lark.

Princess Donut

The Queen Anne Chonk, Donut **brings the magic** to any party she's in. Partnered with her manservant Carl, she's decided it's best for her image to also ally with team Meadow Lark.





Imani

One of the younger nurses of team Meadow Lark, Imani's a **skilled healer** and a threat to Mobs with her enchanted longsword.



Yolanda

Team Meadow Lark's most experienced nurse, Yolanda is a **skilled healer** and **archer** who puts the needs of the nursing home's many elderly patients first.



WELCOME TO THE SECOND FLOOR, GAME MASTERS!

Par for the Course is an introductory scenario for the **Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game**, where players take on the roles of Carl, Donut, Brandon, Chris, Yolanda, or Imani as they rush to lead the elderly residents of team Meadow Lark to safety on the Second Floor of the dungeon.

Be sure to grab the Second Floor versions of these characters! All of the Stat and Skill bonuses have already been applied, so you are ready to go. Some Stats will be higher than their First Floor counterparts due to potions, which increase both the enhanced and unenhanced Stat. Donut's Stats are crazy high due to her Enhanced Growth Buff.

If you're not the Game Master, stop reading now. You'll spoil everything, you cheater!

Just GMs left? Let's do this!

In this scenario, Rosie Quinn (the System AI abbreviates her last name to Q), one of the team Meadow Lark members, becomes trapped inside a magic peanut butter jar by her own grandson. Carl, Donut, and the rest of team Meadow Lark must chase down the kidnapper to rescue Rosie, navigating the twists and turns of Borant's World Dungeon in the process.

If you're here, you're probably already a fan of Carl, Donut, and everything else from the *Dungeon Crawler Carl* book series. If not, now's a good time to read through the other parts of this Starter Set (particularly *Rules for Survival*, *Atlas: Tutorial Floors*, and the ready-to-play character sheets), have some laughs, learn the rules, and prepare yourself for a good time.

This scenario should play in three to four hours, depending on group size and speed, the same block of time used for many convention or game store events. It's also a reasonable length for many gaming groups playing on a Friday or Saturday evening. *Par for the Course* assumes you'll use the ready-to-play versions of Carl, Princess Donut, Brandon, Chris, Yolanda,

and Imani. If you want to create your own characters for this scenario or use it in your own campaign, information about how to adapt the scenario for other characters is on p. 24.

Preparations: Scenarios like *Par for the Course* work best when the GM reads the entire adventure first (this one's short and shouldn't take long!).

Brain Breaks: Don't forget to take breaks if needed! Each of these scenes ends at a reasonable breaking point, allowing GMs five minutes to reread the next scene and let players grab a snack or stretch their legs.

Text Formatted Like This: Text like this is intended for the GM to read out loud verbatim or paraphrase for the players as the scene dictates.

OVERVIEW

Par for the Course begins with Carl, Donut, Brandon, Chris, Imani, and Yolanda escorting the elderly residents of team Meadow Lark toward a saferoom on the dungeon's Second Floor. During a brief lull in the trek, Rosie Q (short for Quinn) asks to join the party for safety, just in time for the Back Nine Battle Baboons to ambush the group (*Prologue; Scene 1: Ambush*). The Baboons move with unsettling coordination, barking and screeching like soldiers following shouted orders.

Inside the saferoom, things immediately go sideways. Rosie's misguided grandson, Derrick Qu (abbreviated from Quinn as well—there was a Derrick Quade that got Derrick Q), appears, traps her inside a magic peanut butter jar, and bolts, only to lose the jar moments later to a passing Battle Baboon (*Scene 2: The Jar Job*). Now everyone is chasing the same target: A Baboon with a kidnapped grandmother in a jar (*Scene 3: The Great Baboon Chase*). Derrick, out of options and running on panic, begrudgingly joins the party.

Fitting this Scenario with the Novels

For anyone who cares about such things (looking at you, Matt Dinniman), this scenario takes place just before Chapter 31 of *Dungeon Crawler Carl*. Roleplaying game scenarios like this one deviate from some events of the novels. Most players expect the GM to make the story their own, and understand they're playing a game not recreating the novels.



GM Tip: Keep the Action Moving

A fantastic introduction to the *Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game*, *Par for the Course* is intended as a fast-paced one-shot, the kind of adventure you might play at a convention, a local game store event, or as a one-off game with your home RPG group. Don't be afraid to make the scenario your own (see *Adapting this Adventure*, p. 24), but it's also okay to encourage players to focus and get through the scenario as necessary. At a convention or store event, most players are used to the need to stay on track.

Here are a few ways to help keep the story moving:

It's Obvious That...: The *It's Obvious That...* technique is helpful, when deployed occasionally, because it clearly tells players they're going down a path that won't work. "It's obvious that you need to rescue Rosie," tells players there's no adventure to be had in turning around and looking for the stairwell down. Use those exact words or something equally clear, and it should solve unnecessary confusion.

Use NPCs: Mordecai (Game Guide for Carl and Donut), Mistress Tiatha (Game Guide for team Meadow Lark), or an unused Meadow Lark crawler might tell the PCs what they need to do. "I'll get everyone into the saferoom! You four go find Rosie!" They can be the voice of an *It's Obvious That...* but it doesn't need to be as heavy-handed. Don't forget, crawlers can send messages to party members across any distance in the dungeon! Game Guides can use other crawlers in a party who are with them to send messages. The same NPC could give (or ask for) updates and advice during the adventure, even if they aren't present.

There's No Time for That: Careful crawlers might want a short rest after every fight. Remind players that their mission is time-sensitive, and the Time to Floor Collapse is ever present. In this scenario, rescuing Rosie is more important than topping off their Health Bars.

From there, it's a sprint through increasingly bad decisions and worse environments. The group navigates applying explosives to a logistical inconvenience (*Scene 4: The Chasm*), fights through Baboon patrols (*Scene 5: The Back Nine Battle Baboons*), and may even encounter a mini-golf trap that the Baboons use as a security system.

In the end, crawlers must defeat General Kong, rescue Rosie, and use everything they've learned to turn the Baboons against their own leader (*Scene 6: Boss Battle—The Kong Country Club Invitational*).

KEY NPCs AT A GLANCE

Rosie Q (Crawler #12,330,787): A warm, slightly scattered elderly woman with a deep love of music and a habit of going off on tangents mid-sentence. She saw a note clutched in the bloody hand of a dead crawler and knows the Boss's weakness—something about golf balls—but can't quite piece it together until the party reaches the Boss's chamber, when the sound of the fight jogs her memory.

Rosie can send chat messages from inside the jar but cannot receive replies; use this to keep her present

and gently nudge the party when needed about the urgency of saving her. She is Derrick's grandmother and views him with a complicated mix of affection, worry, and unwavering belief that he's "a good boy at heart... just confused."

Derrick Qu (Crawler #12,330,875): Rosie's grandson is lean, tattooed, wearing jeans with cowboy boots, and has been wholly convinced for years that aliens are behind everything wrong in his life. The Collapse and this whole dungeon business both prove he was right all along! He's certain the crawlers are part of the conspiracy, and this is a rescue mission.

Derrick isn't malicious... he's just worried about his grandmother and approaching it entirely wrong. He traps Rosie in the magical peanut butter jar, immediately loses it to a Battle Baboon, and ends up running alongside the party out of pure desperation. He reveals his backstory in fragments and likely makes a final, reckless, choice to clear a path into the Boss Chamber. Short of a miracle, his ending feels sudden, heroic, and just a little bit tragic.

PROLOGUE

Type: Logistics and Social Interaction

GM Goal: Quickly introduce the Crawlers and Rosie Q, along with the world of *Dungeon Crawler Carl*

Estimated Time: 10–15 minutes

Rules to Review: None

Begin by setting out all the Second Floor ready-to-play characters so players can choose which character they would like to play. Let players take them on a first-come, first-served basis, roll off to randomly determine an order, or just toss them on the table and let them decide. This shouldn't take long; go ahead and offer a little mediation if folks are struggling.

Par for the Course opens with the crawlers enjoying a rare moment where nothing is actively trying to kill them. Which, in this dungeon, counts as a win. Give the players a quick chance to introduce their characters before the group heads out for the saferoom. Keep it brief—names, a sentence or two, just enough to get everyone oriented.

This is a great time for players to interact with members of team Meadow Lark, including familiar faces like any of the ready-to-play characters not currently being played. Keep the unused sheets nearby in case you need another voice to keep the action rolling. Holding up their sheet and artwork helps players understand who's talking. If they're not being played as PCs, they are focused on helping the residents and won't actively fight or take Actions, but you can describe their general actions, like protecting and corralling the residents.

Next, introduce Rosie Q (Crawler #12,330,787). She is spry, warm, and immediately tries to get to know everyone. Before long, she pulls one of the crawlers aside with surprising directness.

A smiling elderly woman in a green cardigan and torn skirt approaches. Her silver hair is tied into a makeshift bun, and glasses perch loosely on the end of her nose. Despite her age, she carries herself with a straight, confident posture, clearly in better shape than most of team Meadow Lark's elderly members.

"Hi there... It's me, Rosie. I know there are a lot of us to keep track of, but thanks for helping us old folks out. We really appreciate it."

She tilts her head curiously.

GM Tip: Roleplaying Rosie

Rosie is the first NPC the PCs really get to know in this adventure. She's quirky, obsessed with rock music, and a bit spacey. Give her some sentences that don't finish but just... trail... off... Have her act grandmotherly toward PCs by wiping things off their cheeks (like smoke or blood) and make sure she reassures them that she'll remember the info about the area Boss. She also likes talking about her grandson, Derrick, whom she sees as weird but brilliant and well-intentioned. Her friends at Meadow Lark don't all agree about the well-intentioned part if anyone asks around.

"I think we can be friends! First, an important question: Who's your favorite band? I've always been a big fan of Led Zeppelin and Oasis myself, but The Beatles are still my favorite."

Rosie asks each character her band question. If the players are interested in roleplaying this interaction, and you have time to spare, linger on this scene a bit. Rosie loves music in general and is specifically a big fan of rock from the '60s to the '90s. No matter how the characters answer, Rosie nods knowingly as if she's just gained deep insight into their soul. After a little interaction, she leans closer to the group and in a hushed tone says:

"I don't want to be a burden, but I'd feel a lot safer sticking with you lot, if that's all right. My memory's not always great, but I'm spry for my age, I promise. And I can tell you a secret about this area's Boss, General Kong!"

When pressed for the secret, her expression clouds. She claims to have seen a note in the bloody clutches of a dead crawler that the group passed a while back about one of General Kong's weaknesses. But she's sad thinking of the fate of so many crawlers and friends lost along the way, and can't quite remember the details.

"Stress really doesn't help my memory," she shares ruefully. "But I'll try to remember while we walk!"

This seeds the Boss fight mechanic. The memory comes back to her at the start of Scene 6, where she'll send a chat message from inside the jar as the fight begins.



If Rosie, the other Meadow Larks, or even a Game Guide like Mordecai are asked about the area Boss, they can't tell you much other than his name is General Kong, and he leads an army of Baboons. That's all Rosie remembers seeing on the note at this point.

MOVING ON

Before moving on, ensure that the players understand:

- Who their characters are
- Who the other players portray
- Who Rosie is and why she is important

If folks are having fun roleplaying, you can let this scene linger a bit. If you're on a time crunch, move them on to *Scene 1: Ambush* as soon as you can.

SCENE 1: AMBUSH

Type: Combat

GM Goal: Introduce the core resolution mechanic and combat while keeping things exciting

Estimated Time: 15–20 minutes

Rules to Review: The Core Mechanic (p. 12), Combat (p. 30), and Checks Without Skill Ranks (p. 12) all in *Rules for Survival*.

As the characters near the saferoom, their HUDs go a bit static. Suddenly, an Overwhelming number of Back Nine Battle Baboons (2 or more per PC plus more harassing the elderly from afar) pour out of an intersecting corridor and accost the group, so no Surprise round is available to the crawlers. The heroes must keep the residents safe from the attack while getting them to the saferoom. Each crawler (including the elderly residents) has one Baboon attacking them.

GM Tip: Catcher & Taunt

You might remind players that they can attempt to use their Catcher (Brandon) Skill—to take hits for allies—or Taunt (Carl) Skill—to direct attacks at weaker allies to tougher ones. They can even use an active Skill like Taunt untrained (though with Disadvantage). Play up the heroism of any actions to protect helpless oldsters. If any crawlers attempt untrained skills, they should write them down so they can gain 1 Rank in that Skill after playing for 2 hours.

The first Baboon killed falls hard to the ground, whereupon a golf ball that was in her golf slacks pocket pops out and hits the killer, causing all remaining Baboons to target that crawler next round. Do not tell the players why this happens or remind them about who the golf ball hit.

After two or three Baboons have been dispatched (or three rounds of combat at most), the rest retreat in confusion. Depending on the age and emotional state of your players, feel free to off a few nameless Meadow Lark elders here for dramatic flair.

BACK NINE BATTLE BABOON



Back Nine Battle Baboon. Level 4.

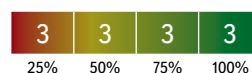
Start with a brown-furred baboon and scale it up to the size of a silverback gorilla. Huge snarling teeth, angry eyes. Now put it in a country club outfit. Polo shirt stretched to the brink of surrender, tucked into khaki slacks with a smart cap and golf gloves. Each one carries a different club—putter, wedge, iron, wood, it doesn't matter which. They all hurt the same. They're aggressive as hell and stop for nothing short of death or golf balls.

Despite the name, they're not related to Earth baboons. And they are definitely not related to the Babababoons on the Fourth Floor.

...which is information you absolutely didn't just hear.

Back Nine Battle Baboon

Mob, Large (5), Primate



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
4	13	14	20 + S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
6 (+3)	1 (+1)	6 (+3)	3 (+2)	1 (+1)

Golf Club: 15 to hit, 1d6+3 Bludgeoning

Notes: If someone is hit by a golf ball, at least 1d4+1 Baboons in the vicinity attack that creature for that round.

Each crawler who survives the fight receives a Bronze “Welcome to the Second Floor” Box containing 1d10 gold. Any crawler who killed a Baboon also finds a single golf ball in their box. Remind the players that they can open their loot boxes in the saferoom.

The AI suddenly chimes in, announcing a new achievement for each of the crawlers.



SO, YOU'VE BEEN AMBUSHED!

"It's a hard-ass world, kiddies, and nobody fights fair. Seeing the way you care for your fellow earthlings is enough to make one cry. Which one, I have no idea."

Gain 1 AI Favor.

Of course, things don't stay calm for long. Unbeknownst to team Meadow Lark, they were followed into the dungeon by Derrick Qu, Rosie's grandson, and he's about to make a very bad first impression.

MOVING ON

Before moving on, ensure that the players understand:

- How the basic rules of combat work
- Combat Skills, Spells, and the working of their characters' items
- How using a Skill untrained works, which is especially important on the Tutorial Floors

Once everyone has made it into the saferoom, move to *Scene 2: The Jar Job*.

SCENE 2: THE JAR JOB

Type: Investigation

GM Goal: Introduce Derrick Quinn and the central conflict of the scenario

Estimated Time: 5–10 minutes

Rules to Review: Core Mechanic (*Rules for Survival*, p. 12), Stat Checks (*Rules*, p. 12), Escalating Difficulty (*Rules*, p. 14)

With the last of team Meadow Lark safely inside the saferoom, the room's protections hum to life, and the crawlers can finally breathe. The saferoom is themed like a mom and pop gas station convenience store, but without the usual "food," stuff, and smells. The surly Bopca Protector inside is a non-combatant NPC named Grunhilda who mostly answers questions with curt, single-word responses or the occasional shrug. Give the players a moment here. They can take a 2-hour short rest if needed to heal up or use their Heal Spell or First Aid, eat Mana Toast (which refills the Mana of the crawler who consumes it), adjust their Hotlists, and decompress. Mordecai might even ask Carl for a status update via a crawler in the saferoom with him.

It's quiet. It's safe. Which, in this dungeon, usually means something is about to go horribly wrong. Once everyone feels at ease, the door opens and Rosie's grandson, Derrick Qu, slips through. He spots Rosie and immediately makes the worst decision of the day.

Note: If a crawler tries to attack Derrick inside the saferoom, the safeguards freeze them, making this a perfect saferoom teaching moment. The peanut butter jar is protection magic and not considered a weapon, so Derrick's action is not flagged as hostile.

The saferoom door unexpectedly opens, and a crawler darts in. Crawler ID: Derrick Qu. He's sporting boot-cut jeans with cowboy boots and a UFO tattoo on his right forearm. He has what looks like an old-timey glass peanut butter jar in his hands.

Before you can react, Derrick opens the empty peanut butter jar, and Rosie is instantly sucked into it, shrinking as she gets closer to it. Before anyone can intercept him, he's back out the door, muttering about the "aliens not getting her" as he goes.

The Meadow Lark crawlers all recognize Derrick Qu, Rosie's grandson. He visited often. Nice, but... a little off. Have Yolanda, Imani, Brandon, and Chris make an INT Stat Check against an Escalating Difficulty (see *Rules*, p. 14) to recall more about him.

Roll 1d20 and add INT. Compare the result to the Escalating Difficulties below. For each Difficulty met or exceeded, reveal that fact. If multiple crawlers succeed, distribute the information so everyone contributes.

- **Difficulty 8:** Derrick worked at a peanut butter factory and frequently brought Rosie her favorites.
- **Difficulty 12:** He tried to convince Rosie to leave Meadow Lark and live with him so he could keep her safe from... aliens? You seem to recall the boy not being all there. Then again, maybe he was the only sane one after all, all things considered.
- **Difficulty 16:** Rosie raised Derrick after a family tragedy.

Rosie is alive but trapped in the peanut butter jar in suspended animation, and Derrick's minimap dot is heading down the twisting maze of corridors in the same direction that the Baboons fled.

Note: Rosie can send chat messages to the party, but any replies bounce back with a "crawler unavailable" message. Use this feature to keep her present in the story by occasionally sending short, worried messages reminding the crawlers she's counting on them, but nothing related to their questions or surroundings.



Once the crawlers have caught up to Derrick enough to see him, Mistress Tiatha, team Meadow Lark's Game Guide contacts the group via chat. Game Guides can't chat with crawlers directly so they need to use an intermediary like Jack or Elle or an unplayed ready-to-play character. If Carl or Donut aren't being played, Mordecai might contact the party via one of those two instead.

"Why's he holding the jar still? Must not be letting him inventory it... only pet carriers do that. If a Mob gets that jar, or it breaks... I have no idea what happens... the suspended animation might be protecting her."

The crawlers can also learn most of Derrick's information by interviewing other Meadow Lark residents in person or via the chat interface, but keep in mind they are very pressed for time if they want to catch Derrick. If the party immediately chases Derrick, proceed to *Scene 3: The Great Baboon Chase*.

Note: If things get really dicey and the PCs need info, use the unplayed ready-to-play characters or Game Guides to explain who Derrick Qu is and about his visits to the Meadow Lark facility. They are staying behind in the saferoom with the residents, as noted previously.

If the party doesn't immediately pursue Derrick, his dot disappears from their minimaps after five rounds. From there, they'll need to track him using the last known direction and point where his signal vanished. Remember,

Rosie's Messages

While the protection of the jar prevents incoming data, Rosie can still send one-way chat messages from inside her hazy peanut butter-glazed jar. Her first message should be about not hurting Derrick:

- "Help! I think my grandson is trying to protect me somehow, but I'm stuck and sticky in here!"

Additional messages at the GM's discretion could include:

- "This reminds me of that song—I'm stuck on you... Oh! No, wait, that's not helpful."
- "If you see Derrick, please don't hurt him. He means well. He just... doesn't always land there."

if the party needs motivation to chase Rosie down, she can still send messages begging to be saved from her sticky situation.

A Successful Unopposed Tracking, Perception, or similar Skill Check (Difficulty 14) allows the party to track Derrick through the maze of corridors until he appears on their map again. He thinks he's escaped the crawlers, but once he's on their minimap again, they begin the chase as outlined below.

Crawler #12,330,875. "Derrick Griffith-Quinn."

Derrick grew up believing aliens were responsible for everything that went wrong in his life. When he was young, his father disappeared, and his mother, not wanting to burden him with the cold reality, told him it was an alien abduction. When she later died of cancer, Derrick became convinced the aliens were targeting his family.

He was raised by his grandmother, Rosie, who tried to give him a normal life. He did well enough on the surface, in sports, and at a job at a peanut butter factory, but he never let go of the childhood belief instilled in him that aliens were always watching.

Eventually, as his paranoia escalated, something convinced him that peanut butter blocked mind-control rays. He tried on numerous occasions to convince Rosie to leave Meadow Lark so he could "protect" her. A rational woman, she refused. On one occasion, he even became so adamant that he had to be escorted off the Meadow Lark premises. The Meadow Lark residents are familiar with Derrick and his story as Rosie talks of him often.

When the collapse happened, Derrick saw it as proof he was right all along. He ran straight to Meadow Lark, saw Rosie being led into the dungeon, and followed, determined to save her no matter what.



"Derrick Qu. Level 7.

I bet you'll need to figure out who the hell this is..."

Derrick Qu

Crawler, Medium (4), Human

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%
Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR					
7	14	16	25 + S	0					
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA					
6 (+3)	3 (+2)	10 (+4)	11 (+4)	3 (+2)					

Nutcracker: 15 to hit, 2d6+3 Bludgeoning

An unarmed strike to the crotch: On an Evade Major Fail or worse, a crawler with external genitals gains the Stunned Debuff

Derrick has the following Skills:

- **Wild Child:** Stealth (2), Survival (3)
- **Weirdo:** Aliens & UFOs (5), Intimidate (3)
- **Peanut Butter Factory Worker:** Fabricate (3), Repair (4)
- **Gym Rat:** Running (5), Swimming (3)
- **Other:** Explosives Handling (5), Throw (3)

MOVING ON

Before moving on, ensure that the players understand:

- Who Derrick Qu is
- They must keep moving to save Rosie Q
- How Stat Checks and Skill Checks work

Once the PCs have decided to chase Derrick, proceed to *Scene 3: The Great Baboon Chase*.

SCENE 3: THE GREAT BABOON CHASE

Type: Chase

GM Goal: Introduce the chase rules.

Estimated Time: 15–20 minutes

Rules to Review: Chasing (*Rules for Survival*, p. 27)

The PCs and Derrick are now quickly going deeper into Baboon territory. This chase involves three checks:

- Jumping over Derrick's junk (17 for Derrick)
- Climbing a steep slope (17 for Baboon)
- Running to catch up (18 for Baboon)

As the GM, you can alter the Skills needed or allow clever ideas to automatically Succeed on a Skill Check. Crawlers attempting Skill Checks without any Ranks roll with Disadvantage (see *Rules*, p. 12), but still get to add their Stat. Later on, they'll have a chance to gain a Rank in that Skill (see *Advancement in Crawlers*, p. 42). You can use Action Tokens to represent Ground crawlers gain. Once someone gains 4 Ground, they've caught the bastard. See *Getting the Jar Early* (p. 16).

Derrick bolts the moment he exits the saferoom. He tips over a Goblin Maintenance Cart, spilling 1d4 Misc. Junk on the floor, to slow anyone who might be following him. This creates a Jumping Skill Check for the first leg of the chase, and Derrick gets a 17.

When the first crawler succeeds in the check, Derrick turns to see who's pursuing him and slams straight into a Battle Baboon coming out of another corridor, going down hard. The peanut butter jar launches into the air, and the Baboon snatches it and is gone in a blur of khaki.

Once Derrick is back on his feet, he's sprinting after the Baboon and shouting incoherently. The chase continues, but now there's a new quarry!

The Baboon runs straight for deeper Kong territory, and other Baboons occasionally join it along the way but are about 30 seconds behind the peloton. Now everyone is chasing something. Baboons are chasing the party. Everyone is chasing the Baboon with the jar.

The area becomes less of a corridor and more of a maze. Ahead, the Baboon with the jar climbs a very steep rocky slope with ease, requiring a Climbing Skill Check for the second leg of the chase. The Baboon gets a 17.

Rosie's Messages

While the protection of the jar prevents incoming data, Rosie can still send one-way chat messages from inside her hazy peanut butter-glazed jar. Possible messages at the GM's discretion could include:

- "I wish I knew what was going on out there!"
- "I think I remember something about the Boss. It has to do with golf... I just need a moment..."
- "Derrick... I can feel you nearby. Please be careful, honey. Let these nice people help you."



Derrick isn't entirely running from the party anymore; he's not thinking about them at all. If the crawlers begin to catch up, he doesn't slow down. He just yells at them to "Keep up or get out of the way! I've got to save Grams!" and throws a cherry bomb haphazardly behind him in the general direction of the Baboons, but slow crawlers could end up feeling the boom. Anyone whose chasing Skill Check is a Major Fail or worse fails to get out of the way, taking 1d6+2 Fire damage.

Once everyone is at the top of the steep slope, it turns into a proper foot race through torch-lit passages. Crawlers should attempt a Running Skill Check, untrained if needed. The Baboon has an 18. Vehicles like the Goblin Chopper roll with Disadvantage, and Spells like Donut's Puddle Jumper have limited sight range.

The chase ends when the jar-carrier makes it to the stone bridge that reaches across a deep chasm, leading

to the heart of Kong's territory. Here are the three outcomes based on the crawlers' Ground in the chase:

- **Total Success (One or more crawlers reach Ground 4+):** These crawlers catch the jar-holding Baboon at the edge of the bridge and can attack him with Advantage in a surprise round. If they take out the carrier in the surprise round, they can pick up the jar—but suddenly have to deal with the riot of Baboons chasing them. If the carrier Baboon lives through the surprise round, it races across the bridge and out of sight.
- **Partial Success (Crawlers end with a highest Ground of 1–3):** These PCs catch up to the Baboon jar-carrier as it runs across the bridge, leaving Derrick and the crawler group in the dust on their side of the bridge. They've lost the jar for now but must face the tons of Baboons chasing them.
- **Total Failure (Crawlers end with 0 or negative Ground):** The Baboon jar-carrier disappears into the distance on the other side of the bridge, and the riot of Baboons that chases the party swipes at any stragglers. Each crawler lagging behind makes a Difficulty 12 CON Stat Check to protect themselves from the worst of the Baboons' strikes. All crawlers take 2d6 Slashing damage, or half that if they succeed on their Stat Check.

GM Tip: The Chase

Chases are fun. They pit adversaries against each other, but, in this case, they don't involve combat. Picture your favorite film foot chases and steal from them... liberally. Like the basket scene in *Raiders of the Lost Ark*, substitute the jar for the basket. The Baboon carries it, the party chases it, and Derrick is right there alongside them, panicking with a growing horde of Baboons behind them all. While they see the numbers they roll, you can imply the Baboon is farther ahead or nearly in reach to dial in the tension.

While highly unlikely, if the players somehow corner Derrick before the jar is stolen, have it get knocked loose during the confrontation. A Baboon grabs it, and the same outcome follows.

If a player manages to throw a golf ball at the Baboon carrying the jar or otherwise distract that Mob, the Baboon drops everything and gives chase. However, another Baboon immediately scoops up the jar without breaking stride. The chase continues with a new carrier. Players can keep trying, but they're burning through golf balls to achieve the same result unless you let them short circuit the whole chase with a good idea and a great roll of the dice.



Getting The Jar Early

If the crawlers heroically gained the jar, they're still faced with overwhelming odds between here and the saferoom. It's still best for them to blow the bridge over the chasm in *Scene 4*.

After that, you'll need to do a little work to change the descriptions in *Scene 5* (Derrick still sacrifices himself to protect the jar and the crawlers) and *Scene 6* (General Kong obviously doesn't have the jar if the players do).

After dealing with your group's outcome, proceed to *Scene 4: The Chasm*. From this point on, Derrick sticks with the party as they try to ditch the Baboons chasing them and track down Rosie. He's sullen and shaking, muttering that he has to get her back but no longer resisting that he needs their help.

Any crawler hit with a cherry bomb during the chase earns this achievement:



ALMOST LOST A FINGER

"Aw, did your widdle fingow get huwt by a widdle firework? You really think you deserve an achievement for that?"

Reward: How about some advice? Move out of the way next time, dumbass."

MOVING ON

Before moving on, ensure that the players understand:

- How the chase rules work

Check to see how long you've been playing since the character introductions. If it's been near or over 2 hours, proceed to the intermission on *Crawler Advancement* (below). If it's only been 90 minutes or so, proceed to *Scene 4: The Chasm*, then come back to the *Intermission* after that scene.

INTERMISSION: CRAWLER ADVANCEMENT

After two real-world hours of play, crawlers improve their lot in life. It's probably time for a breather anyway! Stretch your legs, refill the snacks or beverages, and be sure to urinate and defecate in designated bathroom areas.

If you plan to continue with the ready-to-play characters after this adventure, add 1 level to each character's current value. But you'll have to wait until the Third Floor to see any results from this.

Each crawler (whether this is a one-shot or not) should attempt Skill Advancement Checks where applicable, and then gain Rank 1 in one of the Skills they used untrained during the 2-hour session just completed. If any Skills raise from Rank 4 to 5, look it up in *Crawlers & Customization* to see what your new Rank 5 Upgrade does. Make a note of it in your Skill list. Attacks might gain a die of damage!

See *Character Advancement* in *Crawlers & Customization*, p. 42 for more info.

Once this interlude is over, it's back to the action.

SCENE 4: THE CHASM

Type: Puzzle

GM Goal: Give the party and Derrick a shared desperate moment, cross the bridge, blow it, cut off the horde.

Estimated Time: 15–20 minutes

Rules to Review: Helping with non-combat Skill Checks (*Rules for Survival*, p. 19)

The maze of rocky corridors finally opens without warning into a massive cavern. Most of the floor is simply gone, leaving a deep chasm that drops away into the darkness below. A natural stone bridge with bamboo railings, maybe 20 feet across, is the only way forward. It arcs up slightly in the middle before ramping back down on the far side. Far below the bridge, a rushing river provides an echoing white-noise background tone.

Behind them, the sounds of the Baboon horde are getting closer. Dozens of red dots are pouring down the corridor they just left. It won't be long.

Derrick looks at the bridge. He smiles and instantly has two fistfuls of cherry bombs in his hands from his hotlist.

"I can drop this bridge behind us. But I need someone on the far side with me to set the charges on the supports while the rest of you hold this side and keep the baboons from crossing till I'm ready. Once we're across, nothing will be following us."



He's not ordering anyone around. He's asking. For the first time, he actually needs them and is willing to listen. If anyone is already on the other side, Derrick crosses while speaking, sure that anyone competent enough to have chased down the Baboons can help him with his plan.

If anyone distrusts Derrick and thinks he might blow the bridge before the rearguard crosses, that crawler, and only that crawler, can make a CHA-Opposed Detect Lies Skill Check. No one can Help, as there is too much going on. Success reveals that he doesn't want to hurt anyone and wants all the help he can get to save his grandma.

One or more crawlers can volunteer to cross first with Derrick and help rig the far side while the others hold the near side against the leading edge of the horde. This requires a player to make an Unopposed Explosives Handling Skill Check, and Derrick grants a 1d6 bonus for Helping, as he has the Skill. Alternatively, you could allow a crawler to attempt an Unopposed Engineering Skill Check instead, but at an added Difficulty of +2, and no help from Derrick. If Chris and Brandon are both PCs, one can Help the other for +1d6. The crawler who does the best with rigging the charges earns the "Bridge on the River Quai" achievement.

Use this opportunity while Derrick is rigging for him to open up. His hands are busy, the horde is coming, and something about working loosens him up.

"I'm not gonna hurt her," he says, setting a charge. "She's in danger. The aliens are looking for her, and only I know how to hide her." He's not asking for forgiveness. He's explaining himself while his hands keep moving. Feed whatever backstory beats the players haven't learned yet that you want to share. He's not a talker by nature, but this is the closest he gets.

The remaining crawlers hold the near side. Each crawler holding the line has two Baboons attacking them (another from the horde replaces any defeated ones), and needs only to survive for two rounds. Good hits against the charging Baboons send them into the abyss, with a Wilhelm Scream echoing for too long.

During crawler actions of the second round of combat, they can retreat across the bridge with a Move Action. One crawler needs to be the anchorman, and if the crawlers have had it too easy so far, you could have three Baboons attack them in the second round before they get to the far side.

A Major Fail or worse on an Evade Check during round two means the crawler loses their footing and is now hanging onto the rail with their feet dangling above certain death. Let the players get creative with how to save their unlucky comrade, and let even a Major Fail succeed, but with consequences (see *Rules*, p. 15 for advice on failing forward or succeeding at a cost). Did Brandon just drop his awesome Lightning Maul?

Donut's Puddle Jumper Spell negates this "last to cross danger" for up to four crawlers.



GM Tip: Rolling with Creativity

Players have wild ideas. Don't be afraid to let them roll for wacky ones—a failed roll doesn't mean total failure (see *Failing Forward* in *Rules*, p. 15). Do they want to jump the Goblin Chopper across the chasm? Sure. Swing on a rope? Sure, if they can make a lasso. Players love it when their good (or bad) ideas work.

Once everyone is across, Derrick holds out the detonator to whoever helped him rig it. “Want to do the honors?”

Derrick waits till all party members are safely out of the way before nodding at the crawler who aided him to blow the supports. The bridge drops into the darkness, and any advancing Baboons on the bridge fall with it. The remainder of the horde reaches the edge of the chasm and stops, chittering, furious, and going nowhere.

Nothing follows the crawlers as they continue their pursuit of Rosie.

With the bridge blown and the crawlers heading deeper into Kong's territory, Mordecai, Mistress Tiatha, or an unplayed ready-to-play character reaches out via another crawler's chat while the party is catching their breath to check in (see p. 13) and offers advice. Blowing the bridge was a good plan, but Kong will certainly have a retinue with him in his lair. Unless the jar was recaptured, Rosie has probably been taken to the General, and that's where they'll have to go to rescue her.

The lead crawler on the bridge-blowing detail gets this achievement:



BRIDGE ON THE RIVER QUAI

“Don't be too proud of yourselves. It's much easier to destroy than to create, though you certainly have created a mess. But big explosions are attention-grabbers, so here you go.

Reward: A Gold Builder Box.”

Contents: A coupon for a basic Crafting Table. Useful, if you survive long enough to use it on the Third Floor.

MOVING ON

Before moving on, ensure that the players understand:

- That they're allowed to be creative and solve problems in their own way
- That teamwork is a good way for a party to operate

When the party finally gets across, there's only one way out of the cavern, onward.

If the party didn't do the Character Advancement Interlude, they should do that now.

If the party has breezed through to this point and you're worried the adventure will run short, you can move to *Optional Scene: The Sand Trap*. If you're in a hurry, feel free to skip this scene and proceed to *Scene 5: The Back Nine Battle Baboons*.

OPTIONAL SCENE: THE SAND TRAP

Type: Trap

GM Goal: Introduce traps to the players to make them paranoid in the future.

Estimated Time: 5–15 minutes

Rules to Review: Traps (*Game Master's Campaign Toolkit*, p. 14) Falling Damage (*Rules for Survival*, p. 28)

As the party rounds a corner, the entire corridor is now a pirate-themed mini-golf hole called *The Sand Trap*. It's another tall chamber, but the path is no longer rocky. There's a long astroturf strip with a large sand trap on both sides about halfway down. The greens on either side of the traps are large, while the astroturf strip in between the two sand traps is exactly 1 foot wide. There's a sign where the narrow path starts, reading “The Plank,” and it's the only path a hit ball can take to get to the hole.

A single putter is next to the starting green, but no golf balls are to be found. If the players don't remember that they have some golf balls after a few moments, remind them. A stuffed parrot is perched on top of the sign, and it comes to life as an animatronic character as soon as anyone steps onto the putting green.

“Welcome to Pirate Mini-Golf. I'm Birdie. Arrr ye ready to try out our newest themed green? It's called 'The Sand Trap' and it's a par three.”

Astute players might realize that this is an obvious trap. An Unopposed Detect Trap Skill Check (even untrained) might simply result in a clue:



“What would be the most obvious way to disable a mini-golf themed dungeon trap?”

A crawler can attempt an Unopposed Golfing Skill Check, which is likely made untrained with Disadvantage, but uses their DEX. If the golfer cheats and moves up to the start of The Plank, remove Disadvantage from their check.

All of the other crawlers can Help, each adding 1d2 to the check, and encourage the “helpers” to give a few seconds of actual advice. You can imagine how two to five people yelling at the golfer to hit it hard, softly, or straight might not be that helpful.

Ask the golfer which advice they are going to follow, and only those players get to roll their 1d2s. This introduces the idea that not every Skill Check can be helped by committee. Like seriously... how many people can help with Lockpicking? If the golfer accepts contradicting advice, feel free to negate a Help roll or two.

On an Amazing Success, it's a hole-in-one. On a Critical Hit, it banks off three bumpers, circles the edge of the hole twice, and then hangs on the lip for five seconds before rattling in for a Highlight Reel hole-in-one. On a Standard Success, it makes it across The Plank, but doesn't go in. On any fail, the ball goes into one of the sand traps.

As a par three course, three attempts may be made from the starting green, assuming the crawlers have enough golf balls. After the third shot, Birdie announces, “Aww, too bad.” The hole disappears and only reappears after the crawlers leave the area.

If the ball is in the hole, the trap is disabled. The Baboons are all highly skilled golfers, so this serves as a security system for them. They always sink the ball within three tries. If a crawler moves into the sand or onto The Plank without a golf ball in the hole, the sand trap lives up to its name.

THE TRAPS

The Golfer: The first time a Golf Skill Check results in any fail, an electromagnet in the ceiling switches on. The golfer is now dangling 30ft up in the air, held to the ceiling by the metal putter. The golfer might think that they could have let go long before getting that high up. Oh, yeah?! Have you seen the finger-locks involved in a proper putting grip? Your sub-par grip was even more locked in. See *Falling* (Rules, p 28), but the other crawlers might be able to reduce the damage or rescue them with some creative solutions.

Walk the Plank: The narrow strip bisecting the two sand traps can be walked over to avoid passing through the sand. If the party crosses all at once, the middle half of them are suddenly attacked by a giant hand made entirely of sand in one of the sand traps. If one crawler is the guinea pig, they alone get attacked. Affected crawlers can attempt an Evade Check at Difficulty 14 (no Intervening). On any fail, they are pushed into the sand on the other side of The Plank.

Into the Sand: The first crawler that steps into or is pushed into the sand is sucked into this quicksand trap all the way to their armpits. Crawlers not in the sand can attempt STR Stat Check, with Disadvantage because the sand is a son of a bitch. Each time such a check fails, the victim takes 1d10+2 damage. On a Major Fail or worse, the victim goes under, completely swallowed up, and a new rescue method must be used.

The first victim swallowed feels a metal bar as they grasp for any lifeline. Do they grab it? If yes, they pull up a pirate chest full of buried treasure when rescued. It's a real heavy chest, with a big-ass, old-timey lock on it. Remember what we said about Helping an Unopposed Lockpicking Skill Check?

If the crawlers have had it too easy, any Major Fail (or worse) on Lockpicking can cause a cloud of poison gas to spew out that also stains the crawler's hair, skin, and gear a sickly yellow for the rest of the floor. If you're a bloodthirsty sicko, make up your own damage or effects. On Success, it opens finding 1d6 ×1000 gold, and one random Gold-level magic item, with two bonuses. Roll for what it is on the Randomized Magic Items tables (*Atlas*, p. 28). It could be pirate-, golf-, or monkey-themed.

GM Tip: Improvising

As a GM, part of your job is tailoring events, items, or other elements of the story for your group. Dial the weirdness up or down to fit your group. When the AI can provide a reward or consequence that fits a specific crawler, it does. Past Traumas, Loose Ends, and Regrets are one lens you can use to do this. The theme of a Neighborhood or the events that have already happened at the table are another.



A HOLE IN ONE

"Your steady nerves and expert aim has impressed everyone.

Congrats.

Reward: A Bronze Duffer Box."

Contents: Inside is 1d10 gold and a monogrammed putter granting +2 to the Golfing Skill.



BURIED TREASURE

"The more you suffer, the better the rewards. Rest assured that all traps will reward you this handsomely, I promise.

Reward: A Silver Survivor's Box."

Contents: Inside is 1d10 × 100 gold and a Snarky Safety Snorkel. If you are dying with this item in your Hotlist, it automatically straps on, and a voice like Gilbert Gottfried's calls out for help at a loud volume. It's rather distorted, as the voice comes from the tube and gets increasingly snarky as the rounds tick by.

MOVING ON

While it's possible to pass through this encounter and learn nothing new, hopefully, crawlers learn at least one of the following:

- Traps can pop up anywhere
- Avoiding traps doesn't attract viewers. Escaping them is exciting.
- There are more ways to die than just combat

Proceed to *Scene 5: The Back Nine Battle Baboons*.

SCENE 5: THE BACK NINE BATTLE BABOONS

Type: Combat

GM Goal: Derrick dives into the fray trying to get to the giant doors. If Rosie has already been rescued, stress the importance of killing General Kong or his minions, who harass those crawlers for the remainder of the Floor.

Estimated Time: 15–30 minutes

Rules to Review: Combat (*Rules for Survival*, p. 30)

Rosie's Messages

- "Oh... oh no. I think I know where I am."
- "I think they brought me to him."
- "It's him, isn't it? The big one. The one they listen to."
- "Hurry, Derrick! You're gonna be the one that saves me."

Well over a dozen red dots flare at the edges of the crawlers' minimaps as enraged howls roll through the corridors ahead. As the party turns a corner in the maze of tunnels they've been following, another broadened space opens into a sprawling, surreal expanse.

The golf motif continues, with manicured turf (broken here and there by jagged cracks), scattered debris, and the occasional palm tree. Crooked flags flutter from bent poles, and splintered wooden barrels litter the fairway. The crawlers barely have a moment to take it all in before the angry flashing icons of Baboons surge to meet them, and they're immersed in an active battlefield, with two Baboons per crawler.

Derrick throws himself into the melee with reckless determination, shouting, "Those monkeys stole my grandma!" as he lashes out and shoves his way forward. As Derrick is up front and wading into them, he suffers twice as many attacks as the PCs and loses a Health Bar slot with each hit. He's not even attempting to Evade. Any PCs who try to catch up with Derrick get attacked by additional Baboons and are stopped in their tracks.

Amid the chaos, anyone actively scanning ahead, or even glancing past the immediate threat, spots a massive set of reinforced doors set into the far wall. The doors are constructed from dark metal banded with rivets, their surface etched with fluorescent sigils that flicker faintly in the low light.

Surely that's where Rosie will be. Derrick sees it, too.

Derrick finally makes it to the doors, still absorbing hit after hit. As he drops to one knee, several of the golf club strikes hit the door, making an incredible racket. A deafening roar reverberates from the other side, stopping all of the action. For a moment, it's silent, as if the whole world is holding its breath.

After a beat, sound rushes back in, and the enormous doors open inward with a crash. Suddenly, the largest wooden barrel anyone has ever seen flies out the



GM Tip: Derrick Dies in the End

At this point, Derrick is dying. He's fought like hell to save his grandmother, carving a path through the chaos so the party has their best shot at taking down the General. His lifeless body continues to be struck, ticking down his death clock to 0 all within one round. As he is surrounded, crawlers cannot administer healing potions to him. He likely dies.

While the battle here is fast and furious, it's okay to let his death land in real life. Give the table time to process the loss and sit with the weight of it, because the dungeon sure as hell won't.

If the table gets hung up here or death just doesn't work for your players, feel free to override the script. Maybe someone jams a healing item down his throat before Kong lands in the next scene, or he's just hovering on the edge of death, broken and unconscious. This is your show, and the system isn't above a little fudging for better ratings.

No matter what you decide, Derrick does not really join the Boss fight. He's either dead, out cold, or too wrecked to keep going. If the players spend a lot of resources to save him, he may instead cover the door so more Baboons don't enter.

doorway and smacks straight into the kneeling Derrick before exploding into a spray of fire and wooden debris (see General Kong's Explosive Barrel Attack, below). Any other crawlers within 20 feet of Derrick take half damage (unless they Evade, then 25% damage). Derrick crumples to the ground, as do several Baboons, leaving one Baboon per PC. And now a Boss.

MOVING ON

Before moving on, ensure that the players understand:

- Derrick died a hero, redeemed in the end
- That they're about to enter the toughest fight of this scenario, and Rosie's life is on the line

Move into *Scene 6: Boss Battle—The Kong Country Club Invitational* as the chaos unfolds.

B-B-B-BOSS BATTLE! SCENE 6: BOSS BATTLE — THE KONG COUNTRY CLUB INVITATIONAL

Type: Boss Combat

GM Goal: Defeat General Kong, learn Rosie's clue, and rescue Rosie.

Estimated Time: 20–30 minutes

Rules to Review: Combat (*Rules for Survival*, p. 30)

A massive gorilla comes crashing through the open doors in a single bounding leap, landing hard on the green. Twelve feet of muscle and fury, draped in an

army-green button-up lined with medals and general's stars, he hits the green hard enough to rattle teeth, the impact sending a tremor of dust through the chamber. In his left hand, he clutches the glass peanut butter jar where Rosie is currently trapped.

A fire brigade of juvenile Baboons shuttles new barrels forward for their general. Kong doesn't even glance at them. He simply bares his teeth, reaches down, and grabs a barrel, rolling one each round toward the largest grouping of crawlers.

Read these lines of text in quotes out loud in your best AI Voice:



"B-B-Boss Battle!

General Kong. Level 10.

"He's big, he's mean, he's dressed like a walking midlife crisis, and he runs the worst country club in the universe. And folks, let me tell you... the reviews are terrible.

"Once upon a time, he was just another angry primate with a plumbing problem. But after one broken toilet, two unreliable plumbers, and a four-hour wait window that they never showed up for... something inside him snapped.

"He enlisted, he trained, he rose through the ranks, and now he commands an army of golf-obsessed baboons. Welcome, crawlers... to the Kong Country Club Invitational. Par: 1981. Course hazards include: explosive barrels and violent primates.

"Play it where it lies."

Examples of Rosie's Messages

As the party nears the Boss fight, Rosie remembers her piece of advice, granting Advantage on the first Look for Clues check made by the crawlers.

- "Golf balls! That's it! Throw them. They go crazy for those things."
- She may also chime in during the battle with helpful advice or worried distractions.
- "Please be careful."
- "Quick, pelt him..."
- "Derrick? Where are you?"

When the PCs arrive, Kong has Rosie in the jar. Beating Kong is the goal, but keeping Rosie alive matters too.

LOOK FOR CLUES—GENERAL KONG

The clue Rosie gives the crawlers grants them Advantage on their first Look for Clues Check. The clue the crawler gets is:

"With the help of Rosie's clue and remembering what happened the first time you encountered the baboons, you realize that if a golf ball hits a creature, the baboons will attack them. You could throw balls at Kong!"

General Kong's army is obsessed with golf balls. If a crawler throws a golf ball at Kong and hits (see *Throwing in Crawlers & Customization*, p. 35), 1d4+1 Battle Baboons in the area see it happen and turn on Kong immediately for their next action. Kong wastes one of his Actions retaliating against his own troops, flinging them across the green in rage. These attacks don't cause any damage but do waste their Actions.

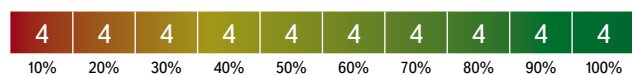
If additional crawlers have Successful Look for Clues checks or if a check reaches a higher degree of Success, they can glean additional information.

"If General Kong is defeated, the remaining baboons will flee."

"The baboons will jump in the way of any very large attacks to protect their General."

General Kong

Neighborhood Boss; Huge (6), Primate



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
10	14	16	20	4
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
19 (+4)	5 (+2)	15 (+4)	10 (+4)	6 (+3)

Kong Smash: 16 to hit, 3d6+4 bludgeoning, 5ft range

Explosive Barrel: 14 to hit, 2d8 Bludgeoning, 60ft range, 20ft Blast radius, (once per round)

Notes: *Commanding*—As an Action, General Kong shouts tactical commands at his Back Nine Battle Baboons to grant them all a bonus of +2 damage to their Golf Swing attacks. He does this only if all of the PCs are at 30% Health Bar or greater, and if there are at least three Baboons remaining.

Tyrannical Loyalty—If General Kong loses 4+ Health Bar slots in a single blow, the nearest Baboon (if any) dives in the way and takes the damage instead.

Jar Crack: The first time any crawler hits Kong with an Amazing Success or better, he drops the peanut butter jar, and it breaks. Rosie comes spilling out, growing to full size, but clearly in trouble. Since the lid wasn't properly removed, she is dying and will be dead after two rounds due to her CON Mod of +2. This creates an immediate dilemma: finish the fight or save Rosie.

When General Kong is defeated, the AI announces: "Winners: the Princess Posse and team Meadow Lark!" Any remaining Battle Baboons flee. Each surviving character gets a bronze star by their name for defeating a Neighborhood Boss, a Neighborhood Map, a Bronze Boss Box, and an Achievement.

With their General defeated, the remaining Baboons lose all interest in the battle and scatter deeper into the dungeon in search of golf balls and easier prey. The lid of the jar unscrews automatically when the holder dies.

Rosie grows to full size as she emerges, and with no ill effects, other than some peanut butter in her hair. If she emerged via the jar cracking open and has been healed up since, she is very groggy and confused. Either way, her gaze lands on the dead body of her grandson, or if Derrick survived, his battered face, and her hand flies up to cover her mouth.



DID YOU HEAR A DING?

Each crawler in the party, including Rosie, gains 1 level for defeating a Neighborhood Boss. If you plan to continue adventures in this area, they can also loot the Neighborhood Map (*Atlas*, p. 22).

EPILOGUE & AFTERMATH

If Derrick died, read or paraphrase the following:

"With her eyes watering, Rosie says, 'He was basically a good boy, you know. Had some weird ideas, but he'd never hurt anyone, and he loved me dearly. Goodbye, Derrick.' She wipes away a tear, squares her shoulders, notices that no one else is crying, and says, 'I don't believe that anybody feels the way I do about you now.'"

"She turns and walks away, humming a comforting hymn under her breath, eventually rejoining the other retirees, dropping from your party."

With the Boss defeated, the crawlers can feel the dungeon rearranging itself. The floor trembles a bit, the green before them begins to turn an unkept brown, and the massive doors reconfigure themselves into nothing more than another corridor entrance before their eyes. Following the clear suggestion from the dungeon and guidance from their minimap, everyone reunites in the previous saferoom with the rest of team Meadow Lark. Here, the crawlers can open all their new loot boxes and review achievements.

Reminder that all loot boxes must be opened in a saferoom, which the crawlers can find soon enough. If the crawlers loot the golf course for the clubs, flags, and everything else, they collectively receive 2d6 Misc. Junk. If you don't plan to continue with these characters, feel free to skip this loot phase and end the adventure.

BRONZE BOSS BOX

Contents: Each crawler receives 1d10 ×100 Gold, two Healing Potions, and a Silver-level magic item. Spell-focused crawlers gain a new utility Spell, melee combatants earn a new DR 1 piece of armor or a replacement weapon if needed, or feel free to use the Randomized Magic Items tables instead (see *Atlas*, p. 26).

The crawler who landed the killing blow on Kong finds an additional item in their loot box: a Four-Star General Pin (see *Items*, p. 24).

The first crawler who gets hit for 10+ damage by one of Kong's explosive barrels gets the the Not Jumpman Achievement.

Any crawler who was dropped to 0% Health Bar by one of Kong's barrels gets the the Bomb Squad Achievement.

Any PC who hit Kong with a thrown golf ball gets the Reading the Green Achievement



THE KINGS OF KONG

"You've defeated a major warlord and his army of baboons. You got the monkeys off your back, though I can't say much for your short game. No, that wasn't a dig at Donut."

Each crawler gains 1 AI Favor.

Some of you might gain another AI Favor from your most-used attack.



NOT JUMPMAN

"You got hit by a barrel. Mario would be so ashamed of you."

Reward: A Bronze Plumber's Toolbox."

Contents: 1d10 gold, 1 Misc. Junk, and cheap, blue overalls with Damage Resistance 1.



BOMB SQUAD

"You do know that bombs can be disarmed *before* they blow up in your face, right? How are you even still alive?"

Reward: A Gold Explosive Box."

Contents: 1d6 ×1000 gold and a magical Bomb Lure. A single-use item that, when activated, attracts all explosives within 100 feet to its location and then detonates them.



READING THE GREEN

"So you figured out the golf ball clue and had enough of an arm to hit the old boy. You're a regular Sherlock Holmes."

Reward: A Gold Gratitude Box."

Contents: 1d6 ×1000 gold, 50mg of cocaine, and a plastic Jr Detective Magnifying Glass that grants +3 Investigation Skill when held.

ITEMS

PEANUT BUTTER OF ALIEN PROTECTION



If cracked open, the suspended animation spell is broken and the jar is worthless.

This jar of peanut butter was crafted by Peter Pan and enchanted by the dark witches of—oh, forget it. Let me just point out that this is possibly the most ridiculous item in the dungeon so far, and that’s saying something.

Unscrew the lid and point the open jar at your target to capture a creature within 50 feet and store it in the jar via suspended animation. Only one Medium or smaller creature (size 4 or less) may be held at a time. A creature inside the jar is completely immune to damage from any aliens or Mobs until released. The suspension is one-directional: a creature inside cannot be harmed or receive messages, but may retain a faint, dream-like awareness of their surroundings; for example, they may sense the sounds of battle around them.

While there is a living creature inside the jar, the jar cannot be placed into a crawler’s Inventory. A creature trapped within the jar can be released by simply opening it. If the individual holding the jar dies, the jar opens automatically, releasing its prisoner. If cracked open, destroying it forever, the occupant is released and gains the Dying Debuff.

There are 15 lines on the barcode, 12 of which are red, three green. That means there are three charges left.

FOUR-STAR GENERAL PIN

It’s one of those buttons with a pin on the back so you can attach it to your shirt. It’s four silver stars on an army-green background. Originally, it was going to be an elaborate shoulder board with four stars of actual silver, but frankly, this was way easier.

When worn visibly as an Accessory, it grants a +3 bonus to Charisma when interacting with military personnel of any kind. It provides +1 Charisma in all other circumstances, because everyone loves a crawler in uniform.

ADAPTING THIS ADVENTURE

While this scenario was designed to work with the ready-to-play characters in this box, you can easily adapt it for other crawlers and bring some of the characters into an ongoing campaign.

USING THIS SCENARIO WITH OTHER CRAWLERS

If you want to use this scenario with other Player Characters, go right ahead! You can easily recast team Meadow Lark as another large group of crawlers in need of help. Or you can try one of these alternate scenarios:

- Your party comes across team Meadow Lark as they get ambushed. Carl and Donut are adventuring elsewhere. Brandon, Chris, Imani, and Yolanda stay to defend the main group while asking your crawler party to go after Derrick. If the PCs were looking for a specific item or piece of information, Rosie has it, possibly including the Boss’s weakness.
- If your party has its own crawler ally or another type of NPC ally, Derrick can be tied to that NPC and kidnap them instead. It might require a little more improvisation with Derrick’s backstory, but the stakes will be higher for the players.
- If a player couldn’t make it to the game tonight, that player’s character could be the one kidnapped. It’s best if the player in question is okay with this option, and you may opt to have Derrick survive (see *Continuing the Story*, below) to return later.

CONTINUING THE STORY

- What class does Rosie choose on the Third Floor? What kind of crawler does she become? She could become a recurring ally for the heroes or someone who goes bad. She’s a good candidate for a Bard-type class. If the party wasn’t entirely friendly with her or didn’t trust her, maybe the aliens break her and convince her that the party is responsible for Derrick’s demise.
- Since the AI spoiled the Babababoons in *Scene 5*, make sure your party encounters them if they get to the Fourth Floor. (see *Junkyard Jumble* in the *Core Rulebook*)
- The Peanut Butter of Alien Protection could be abused in a saferoom. This is a great example of how you can let players use it once, and patch it on the next day so its power is considered an attack (see *Rules*, inside back cover).